

Software Requirements

1.1 Purpose

This document outlines the functional requirements for a custom, web-based platform designed to support the organization's mentorship programs, event management, and community outreach efforts. The primary objective is to replace manual processes (such as relying on Google Drive and basic spreadsheets) with an automated, user-friendly digital system. The platform will make it easy for community members to find mentors and register for events, while keeping ongoing operational and software costs minimal.

1.2 Scope and Monetization

The Rise All platform is a strictly free, non profit community model. In-app payments, platform fees, and mentor payouts are strictly out of scope. Sessions will be conducted using external video conferencing (Zoom). The platform will automatically generate and email the meeting link upon booking confirmation.

1.3 User Roles

- **Visitor** (unregistered user)
- **General User** (Registered with a basic account)
- **Admin** (Operations Team)
- **Mentors**
- **Mentees**
- **Volunteers**

Functional Requirements

1. General Users (Visitors)

- **FR1:** The platform shall allow anonymous Visitors to browse basic mentor profiles (name, industry, bio) and view upcoming events.
- **FR2:** The platform shall allow Visitors to create a basic account with Name, Phone Number, Email address and password.
- **FR3:** The platform shall require users to log in to view a mentor's real-time availability calendar and book a session.
- **FR4:** The platform shall allow general users to register for events by submitting their full name, email address, phone number, current profession, interest in mentorship/volunteering, and preferred event types.

- a. If the user is not signed up with a basic account, then all the above info is asked.
 - b. If the user is already signed up with a basic account, then their name, phone number and email isn't asked again.
- **FR5:** The platform shall send an automated email confirmation upon event registration and a reminder 24 hours before the event starts.
- **FR6:** The platform shall automatically close event registrations once a predefined maximum registration limit or seat capacity is reached.
- **FR7:** The platform shall allow general users to create a mentee, mentor and Volunteer account without re-typing name, email and password.

2. Operations Team (Admin)

- **FR8:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to securely log in and access an administrative dashboard.
- **FR9:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view the list of Mentee/Mentor/Volunteer accounts.
- **FR10:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to create, edit, publish, and archive events.
- **FR11:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view event registrations and attendee lists.
- **FR12:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to review and add notes to mentor applications, request additional information, perform background checks where required, and approve or reject mentor applications.
- **FR13:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view mentor/mentee profiles and their operational metrics.
- **FR14:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to view upcoming, completed, and cancelled mentoring sessions.
- **FR15:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to update website content, announcements, FAQs, mentorship program information, resume review sessions, mock interview sessions, and career guidance content.
- **FR16:** The platform shall provide the Operations Team with dashboards and reports displaying mentor activity, mentee activity, mentoring sessions, event registrations, mentor applications, and community growth metrics.
- **FR17:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to manage automated notifications for registrations, confirmations, reminders, approvals, onboarding, application status updates, missed sessions, and upcoming events.
- **FR18:** The platform shall allow the Operations Team to manage mentor and mentee accounts, and assign or revoke administrative privileges where multiple administrators exist.

3. Mentors

- **FR19:** The platform shall allow general users to apply to become a mentor by submitting an online form containing Professional Bio, Resume (CV), LinkedIn profile, current role and years of experience.
- **FR20:** The platform shall require mentors to review and accept the Mentoring Toolkit guidelines via an online checkbox agreement prior to completing a mentor application or scheduling a session.
- **FR21:** The platform shall allow mentors to set, update, and manage their general and recurring availability schedules, including setting weekly or monthly mentorship hour limits.
- **FR22:** The platform shall allow mentors to block out specific dates or time slots when they are unavailable for mentoring sessions.
- **FR23:** The platform shall allow mentors to accept or decline incoming mentoring requests from mentees.
- **FR24:** The platform shall allow mentors to view and manage their upcoming mentoring sessions and view only their own operational metrics.
- **FR25:** The platform shall track missed appointments, but these metrics (no-show rates) shall only be visible privately on the mentor's dashboard and to the Operations Team, not on the public directory.
- **FR26:** The platform shall schedule mentoring sessions with mentors' external calendars, specifically supporting Google Calendar and Microsoft Outlook.
- **FR27:** The platform shall send automated alerts to mentors who have not updated their availability calendar within a configurable timeframe.
- **FR28:** The platform shall allow active mentors to update their listed areas of specialization, skills, and personal contact details at any time.

4. Mentees

- **FR29:** The platform shall allow mentees to register using current role, start date, mentorship goals, area of interest, education background and level, and accept the mentorship compliance agreement during sign-up.
- **FR30:** The platform, once signed in, shall display individual mentor profiles containing professional background, linkedin, skills, languages, availability status, and a direct booking link.
- **FR31:** The platform shall allow mentees to create and update their profile.
- **FR33:** The platform shall allow mentees to search mentors by expertise, industry, skills, or domain.
- **FR32:** The platform shall display mentors' available time slots and allow mentees to book mentoring sessions by selecting an available date and time and specifying a goal for the session.
 - a. (Time Zones): The platform shall store all dates and times in UTC and dynamically display them in the viewing user's local time zone. Every booking slot will explicitly display the time zone.

- b. (Session Delivery): Upon a mentee booking a session, the platform shall generate a unique external meeting link (through zoom/google meet) and distribute it to both parties via email.
- **FR34:** The platform shall send booking confirmations and reminder notifications to mentees.
- **FR35:** The platform shall allow mentees to view upcoming and previous mentoring sessions.
- **FR36:** The platform shall allow mentees to cancel or reschedule mentoring sessions in accordance with the organization's policy.
- **FR37:** The platform shall allow mentees to submit feedback after completed mentoring sessions.

5. Volunteers

- **FR38:** The volunteer sign-up form shall require users to select their 'Area of Interest' from a predefined dropdown (IT, Marketing, Designing) and specify the hours they can dedicate per week when signing up.
- **FR39:** The platform shall allow active volunteers to transition into or register for mentee/mentorship roles directly within the system.
- **FR40:** Volunteers are allowed to expand their outreach activities aimed at recruiting new mentees and raising group awareness.
- **FR41:** The platform shall provide volunteers to assist staff with event setup, attendee tracking, and platform administration.
- **FR42:** The platform shall allow volunteers to view upcoming workshops, training sessions, and community outreach campaigns assigned by the administrative team.

Non-Functional Requirements

- **NFR1: Cost:** The platform shall keep monthly infrastructure expenses strictly within a non-profit budget of roughly \$60 to \$150/month. It will leverage free or low-cost tiers for databases and transactional emails until high user traffic justifies paid upgrades.
- **NFR2: Usability & Accessibility:** The platform must be fully responsive and work smoothly on mobile phones. It shall meet WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility standards, ensuring proper color contrast, keyboard-only navigation, and screen reader compatibility so users with visual or physical disabilities can easily navigate the platform.
- **NFR3: Security:** The system shall encrypt all user passwords and personal data. The platform shall provide secure authentication, role-based access control, and collect and store only the user data necessary for the operation of the mentorship platform.
- **NFR4: Performance:** The platform shall provide fast and reliable performance for event registration, mentor search, and mentoring session scheduling. Mentor directory searches must return results in under 500 milliseconds, and core pages (booking, directory) must become fully interactive in under 2.5 seconds on a standard mobile connection.

- **NFR5: Scalability:** The platform shall support 10,000 registered users and handle up to 500 people using it at the exact same time without slowing down. The platform must maintain 99.5% uptime each month.